DepotDownloader 3.4.0 source audit

Reviewed October 11, 2026. Safety rating: Medium.

The Medium rating reflects unencrypted storage of Steam login tokens and password exposure through command-line arguments.

The ZIP matches the official SteamRE DepotDownloader_3.4.0 source archive byte for byte. Its 34 files contain source code, project files, build workflows, documentation, and images. No advertisements, bundled offers, separate telemetry endpoint, browser credential harvesting, or Windows startup persistence were found in the reviewed source.

Credential security

Login details are passed to SteamKit2's Steam authentication session (DepotDownloader/Steam3Session.cs:438-453). The application accepts a username and password on the command line. Supplying only the username opens an interactive password prompt that suppresses console echo. QR login is also available (Program.cs:67-70,347-395; Steam3Session.cs:468-521). The reviewed application code contains no password transfer to an unrelated endpoint. Authentication transport is implemented in the external SteamKit2 dependency.

The login handler saves returned refresh tokens and Steam Guard data in account.config, within the user's .NET isolated storage (Steam3Session.cs:509-530; AccountSettingsStore.cs:24-28,45-84). Storage uses protobuf serialization and Deflate compression without application-level encryption. A program that obtains a valid token may be able to access a Steam session, subject to Steam's token restrictions.

The -remember-password option controls reuse of saved tokens and requests a persistent authentication session. Saving the returned token occurs regardless of that option (ContentDownloader.cs:299-315; Steam3Session.cs:445-452,472-476,509-530). Whether Steam returns a usable refresh token for a nonpersistent session was not established by this source review.

The -debug option prints network event data to the console, including available connection and request metadata (Program.cs:54-65; HttpDiagnosticEventListener.cs:14-43). Password or request-body exposure through those events was not established. For password entry, use the interactive prompt to avoid storing the password in the command line. QR login avoids entering the password into the tool but still uses the token-storage code described above.

Network and file behavior

SteamKit2 handles Steam authentication, app information, licenses, manifests, and content delivery. Published-file and user-generated-content downloads use URLs returned through Steam metadata (ContentDownloader.cs:338-400). Requests identify the client as DepotDownloader/<version> (HttpClientFactory.cs:17-27). Downloads, manifests, and state files are saved to the selected or default output directory. No process launching, registry autorun entries, scheduled tasks, or Windows service creation were found in the application source.

The project targets .NET 9 and references SteamKit2, protobuf-net, QRCoder, and Windows CsWin32 (DepotDownloader.csproj:1-31). The README's .NET 8 reference is outdated. GitHub workflows build and publish release packages; the inspected ZIP contains the source rather than those compiled packages.

Scope

This review covered the source archive, execution conditions, credential handling, network calls, file operations, and build configuration. Application code was not run. Compiled release binaries, NuGet dependency code, SteamKit2 authentication transport, runtime network traffic, and downloaded content were outside the review. File references above are relative to the archive's DepotDownloader source folder unless otherwise specified.